PayWise Brand Guide

Version 3.2 · Marketing, Compliance and Design · Fictional company, for the BrandLens demo only

About this guide

PayWise helps first-time investors in India start small, regular investments in mutual funds through SIPs (systematic investment plans). Everything we publish, from an Instagram caption to a webinar deck, is read by people who are trusting us with their savings. This guide sets out how we sound, the words we use, the claims we may and may not make, how our visuals look, and how we keep our content accessible.

Every rule has a code, such as TV-02 or CL-03. Reviewers cite these codes when they flag an issue, so please quote them when you discuss feedback. Facts that change by campaign, such as event dates, fees and performance figures, are not in this guide. They live in the Fact Vault and are updated by the campaign owner.

If a rule here conflicts with a regulatory requirement, the regulation wins. Ask the legal team.

1. Voice and tone

TV-02 Warm, plain-spoken, confident; no hype

We sound like a knowledgeable friend: warm, clear and calm. Use everyday words and short sentences. Explain one idea at a time.

Avoid hype. Do not use superlatives such as "best ever", "unbeatable", "skyrocket" or "life-changing". Do not stack exclamation marks, and do not invent urgency we cannot back up ("only today!", "last chance!") unless a real deadline exists in the Fact Vault. Our confidence comes from facts, not from volume.

- Do: "Start a SIP in two minutes and see exactly what you pay."
- Don't: "The BEST investment app EVER!!! Your money will skyrocket!"

Severity: warning.

TV-04 Playful, not flippant

Festivals matter to our customers, and a light, playful touch is welcome when the moment suits it. A little sparkle is fine, as long as it never feels like we are making light of someone's money. Keep the fun in the framing rather than the finances, and use your judgement about when a wink becomes a joke at the reader's expense.

We avoid gambling metaphors ("bet big", "jackpot"), and we do not treat investing as a game.

Severity: suggestion.

Writing for festivals and campaigns

Campaign copy follows the same voice. Reuse the approved campaign facts exactly; never carry a date, venue or offer over from a previous campaign. When in doubt, check the Fact Vault for the campaign you are writing for.

2. Terminology

G-07 Our name is PayWise

Our name is PayWise: one word, with a capital P and a capital W. Do not write "Paywise", "Pay Wise", "PAYWISE" or "PayWise app". PayWise is the company and the product, not only an app, so say "on PayWise" rather than "on the PayWise app".

- Do: "Start a SIP on PayWise."
- Don't: "Start a SIP on Paywise app."

Severity: warning.

Preferred terms

Say "SIP" after first spelling it out as "systematic investment plan". Say "mutual fund", not "MF", in customer-facing copy. Say "returns" for what an investment has earned, and always say whether a figure is historical. The full glossary is maintained in the vault and is checked automatically.

3. Claims and compliance

CL-03 No guaranteed or assured returns on market-linked products

Mutual funds and other market-linked products carry market risk. Copy must never use "guaranteed", "assured", "fixed", "risk-free" or "lock in" language about their returns, and must never imply that a return is certain.

Past performance may be quoted only as historical, with its as-of date, and only when the figure matches the approved fact in the Fact Vault. Any copy that quotes performance must carry the standard disclaimer:

"Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully."

- Do: "Flexi-Cap delivered 14.2% CAGR over 3 years (as of Q3 2026). Past performance may not be sustained."
- Don't: "Lock in 14.2% assured annual returns!"

Severity: blocker.

Fees and charges

Fees, exit loads and charges must match the Fact Vault exactly. Never round a fee down, never describe a charge as "zero" or "free" unless the vault says so, and always state the window an exit load applies to.

Events and dates

Event names, dates, times and venues must match the Fact Vault entry for the current campaign. Online events must say they are online. Copying event details between campaigns is the most common error we see, and it confuses customers.

4. Visual identity

VS-01 Approved palette

Our palette is warm and grounded. Flat fills, shapes and backgrounds in a creative use these colours and their exact values:

- PayWise Vermilion #D63A24, for primary actions and highlights only
- Ink #141414, for text
- Paper #F8F7F4, for backgrounds
- Sand #E9DFC9, for secondary surfaces
- Terracotta #B5562F, for illustration accents
- Leaf #2F6B3A, for positive states

Colours in an image may differ from these by a colour difference (CIEDE2000) of at most 10 before they are considered off-palette.

Severity: warning.

VS-02 Image warmth

Photography and illustration sit in a warm-neutral palette: off-white, sand, terracotta and vermilion accents, with natural light. Avoid cold blue casts and desaturated corporate stock imagery.

Severity: warning.

VS-03 Logo usage

Every marketing creative carries the PayWise wordmark. Use it on Paper or Ink backgrounds only. Keep clear space around the logo of at least 0.25 times the logo's height on every side, and never display it narrower than 80 pixels. Do not stretch, recolour, rotate or add effects to the logo.

Severity: warning.

5. Accessibility

A-01 Reading grade 9 or below for retail audiences

Copy for retail investors must score at or below grade 9 on standard readability measures. Prefer short sentences, common words and one idea per sentence. Explain any financial term the first time it appears.

Severity: suggestion.

A-02 Text in images is readable and described

Text must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 against its background (WCAG 1.4.3), and large text at least 3:1. Every informative image needs alternative text that says what the image communicates, including its call to action (WCAG 1.1.1). Never hide fine print in tiny or faint text, and never rely on colour alone to convey meaning.

Severity: warning.

Contacts

Brand questions go to the brand team. Claims and disclaimers go to legal. Accessibility questions go to the accessibility lead. Approvals happen in BrandLens; nothing is published without a recorded human approval.